The usual ratio of respiration rate and pulse rate is 1 to 4

The normal respiration rates are

Age	Rate breaths/min
New born	35-40
Infant	30-50
Toddler	25-32
Child	20-30
Adolescent	16-20
Adult	12-20

5.7.1 Besides Age, Factors Affecting Respiration Rate:

1. Sex: respirations are generally more rapid in females than in males
2. Exercise: increases the rate
3. Emotions: such as fear influence respiration
4. Heat: such as hot water or hot both causes increase in rate and decrease in depth of breathing
5. Cold makes the breathing full and deep
6. Drugs: Like sedatives, slow the respirations
7. Respiratory illness: increase the rate especially pneumonia
8. Pain, fever, anaemia, haemorrhage and shock increase the rate
9. Coma and brain injuries – cause decrease in respiration rate.

Procedure:- (counting respiration)

1. The patient must be at rest and unaware that respiration is being taken. It is therefore wise to take while keeping fingers on the pulse
2. Feel or watch the rise and fall of the patient's chest
3. Count each rise and fall as on respiration count for a full minute
4. While counting the rate, note also
   a) Rhythm - Regular or irregular
   b) Depth - Shallow, normal or deep
   c) Sound - quiet and noisy
   d) Any discomfort or difficulty in breathing

5.7.2 Alteration in Breathing Pattern

Bradypnoea - Abnormal slow respiration less than 10/min

Tachypnoea - Abnormal high respiration greater than 30-min

Apnoea - Absence of respiration for several seconds

Hyperventilation - Rate and depth of respiration increases

Hypoventilation - Rate and depth of respiration is very low

Cheyne – Strokes respiration - Respiratory cycle begins with slow, shallow breaths that gradually increase to abnormal rate and depth. This pattern reverses: Breathing slows and become shallow climaxing in apnoea before respiration resumes.

Nursing-Gen_Chapter 05.indd 71 07/05/18 12:48 PM